

INDUSTRY TREND ANALYSIS

# Regulated digital money moves into the core

Scaling · Evidence current to 27 August 2026

The signal

Tokenized deposits, central-bank money, treasury, custody, and programmable settlement are developing into regulated financial infrastructure.

|                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>\$320 billion</b></p> <p>stablecoin market capitalization at end-May 2026, according to BIS. <sup>[1]</sup></p> | <p><b>\$30 billion to \$88 trillion</b></p> <p>current digital real-world assets and the upper-bound 2035 shift in investable assets described in the Weekly Brief; the latter is a scenario, not a forecast certainty. <sup>[2]</sup></p> | <p><b>&gt;\$20 million annually</b></p> <p>savings reported after Siemens reduced global bank accounts and cash pools by more than half using programmable payments. <sup>[2]</sup></p> |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## What is changing - and why it matters

Digital money is moving from a crypto-adjacent topic into regulated payments, treasury, custody and settlement infrastructure. The most credible path is not one winning token; it is a layered architecture combining trusted money, programmable rails and tokenized assets. Incumbents face revenue risk, but they also possess licenses, clients, balance sheets and compliance capabilities that can be turned into advantage.

Executive implication

Digital money is moving from a crypto-adjacent topic into regulated payments, treasury, custody and settlement infrastructure. The most credible path is not one winning token; it is a layered architecture combining trusted money, programmable rails and tokenized assets. Incumbents face revenue risk, but they also possess licenses, clients, balance sheets and compliance capabilities that can be turned into advantage.

## Action agenda

- Separate strategies for crypto, stablecoins, tokenized deposits and real-world assets.
- Prioritize cross-border payments, treasury and collateral workflows with clear economics.
- Preserve optionality across interoperable networks rather than betting on one provider.

## What could change the view

- Regulation fragments faster than interoperability improves.
- Tokenization adds technical layers without shortening settlement or releasing liquidity.

## Selected evidence

[1] Authoritative research · BIS · 2026-06-29 · **Anchoring Trust in Money: Innovation Beyond Stablecoins** · p. 12

[2] Weekly Brief · 2026-08-04 · **Getting Real About Digital Assets**

[3] Weekly Brief · 2024-03-25 · **Banking at a Crossroads**

[4] Authoritative research · BCG · 2026-05-18 · **The Future of Digital Assets**

[5] Authoritative research · J.P. Morgan · 2026-05-06 · **Payments Outlook 2026: Five Shifts Powering Payments**

This independent analysis connects the available Weekly Brief archive with selected authoritative research. Forecasts and company-reported figures are identified in context. The complete evidence list remains available on the website.